Ankit Das (name changed), an employee with a top IT firm in Bengaluru, is losing sleep. In his 30s, he had recently moved his family to the city. He had spent four and a half years at the firm, working on the same project. He had been getting a satisfactory 'C' band at employee evaluations, and his Work From Office index, which tracks an employee's adherence to the company's mandated office attendance policy, was "100 per cent". But suddenly, without explanation, he has been 'benched' (i.e. not on any project) and put on a 'fluidity list'—if your name appears on this list, you will likely be subject to layoff or restructuring. "Initially, my project manager told me I am getting released from the project due to cost-cutting, but he told my delivery manager that my performance is not good," Das said in a Facebook post on August 12. "It's been 12 days in bench, not getting calls on domain (Linux, VMware, AWS, Ansible, GIT etc)," he says, fearful of his company's new 35-day bench policy after which one could face the axe.

As global uncertainty deepens, driven by the ongoing wars in Ukraine and Israel, trade disruptions caused by Donald Trump's tariffs, and the rapid upheaval led by Artificial Intelligence (AI), tech companies worldwide are going through a churn. In calendar year 2025 alone, large tech firms such as Intel, Microsoft and Meta laid off over 60,000 staff globally; tech pundits predict more layoffs in the coming days. The tremors have reached India, too, with Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), India's largest IT services company, letting go of 12,000 employees in July, nearly 2 per cent of its total workforce. According to talent solutions firm Xpheno, 7,700 other senior professionals with over 15 years of experience have exited from the top seven IT firms over the past 12 months.

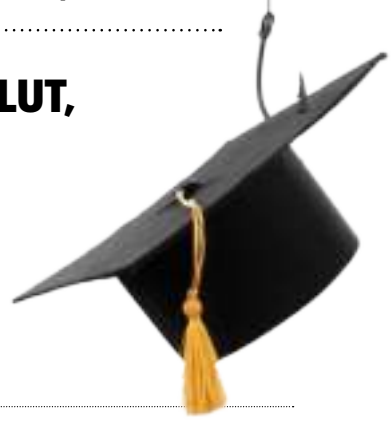
The storied Indian IT sector, which employs 7.3 million people, is facing strong headwinds that threaten to shake its foundation and mandate a structural reset. According to brokerage firm Kotak Institutional Equities, large IT services

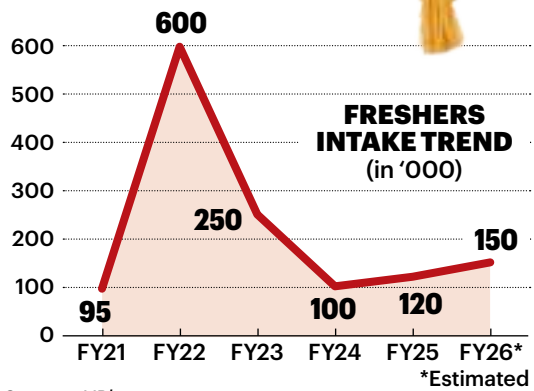
THE HIRING AND FIRING RANGE

FY22 saw what is called 'revenge hiring' in the sector in the aftermath of the COVID-19 pandemic, but the exuberance has petered out considerably since

AFTER THE GLUT, THE FALL

After massive hiring in a single year (FY22), recruitment in the next three years has been lukewarm





Source: XPheno



"In the earlier waterfall models, we had **multiple leadership layers. That's changing**"

— K. KIRTHIVASAN
CEO, TCS, in a media interview

60,000
Staff big tech firms like Intel, Meta and Microsoft let go in calendar year 2025

7,700
Professionals with 15+ yrs experience who have exited from top seven IT firms in the past year

12,000
No. of employees fired by TCS this July